borderlands of Afghanistan and now Pakistan. The geographical area claimed by the movement varied from time to time. Originally the three princely states of Chitral, Pir and Swat and the six agencies of tribal territory between the North West Frontier Province and the Durand Line, which constituted the boundary between British India and Afghanistan, were included in the proposed state. After the emergence of Pakistan as an independent state in August 1947, Pakhtoonistan became a matter of dispute between the Pakhtoons, Afghanistan and Pakistan.

At a conference held in Karachi between representatives of Afghanistan and the new nation of Pakistan, the Afghans made no territorial or population claims, but demanded that the frontier Pathans should be given the right of self determination. Meanwhile Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan, also known as 'Seemant Gandhi,' formed the Pakistan People's Party in March 1948 and one of its objectives was an autonomous Pakhtoonistan within Pakistan, giving up the demand for independence.

The premier of the frontier province arrested Ghaffar Khan in June 1948, although the governor had reported that at that time, Pakhtoonistan had not been mooted as a serious demand by anyone in the frontier. The only sense in which the movement had any reality seemed to be a disinclination of the people to be linked with Punjab. The Afghan government openly sponsored the cause of Pakhtoonistan and as the agitation gathered support, made finances available to the movement as well.

The 1955 merger of the North West Frontier Province (NWFP), Sindh and Punjab into one unit was also considered by the Afghan government as an effort by Pakistan to destroy the